



SkillHub Education

NCFE LMS

Assessor Guide

An operational manual for assessors. Planning assessments, mapping evidence to criteria, signing off learner work, and reviewing portfolios.

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Production URL <https://ncfe-lms.onrender.com>

Awarding body NCFE / CACHE

Contents

1. Overview	Data model, production URL, support contact
2. Signing in	Sign-in page and lost-password routing
3. Assessor tasks	Sidebar reference and the workflows
3.1 Plan an assessment	Title, kind, plan, criteria
3.2 Map evidence and sign off	Send to learner
3.3 Per-criterion comments	
3.4 Export an assessment as PDF	
3.5 Witness testimony evidence	Structured fields
3.6 Review portfolio and progress	
3.7 Log work hours for a learner	
4. Reference	Evidence kinds, file limits, email
5. Assessor FAQ	Common questions

1. Overview

NCFE LMS is the SkillHub Learning Management System for UK vocational qualifications. It supports the full assessment lifecycle from learner onboarding through to IQA sign-off across four roles: **admin**, **assessor**, **student/learner**, and **IQA**. This guide covers the **assessor** role specifically.

Where you fit in the data model

Centre → Qualification → Unit → Learning Outcome → Assessment Criterion

User (with role) ■ Enrolment ■ Assessment ■ Evidence ■ IQA Decision

An **Enrolment** links a student to a qualification under a specific assessor and cohort. An **Assessment** sits inside an enrolment and maps one or more evidence files to one or more Assessment Criteria.

Production URL

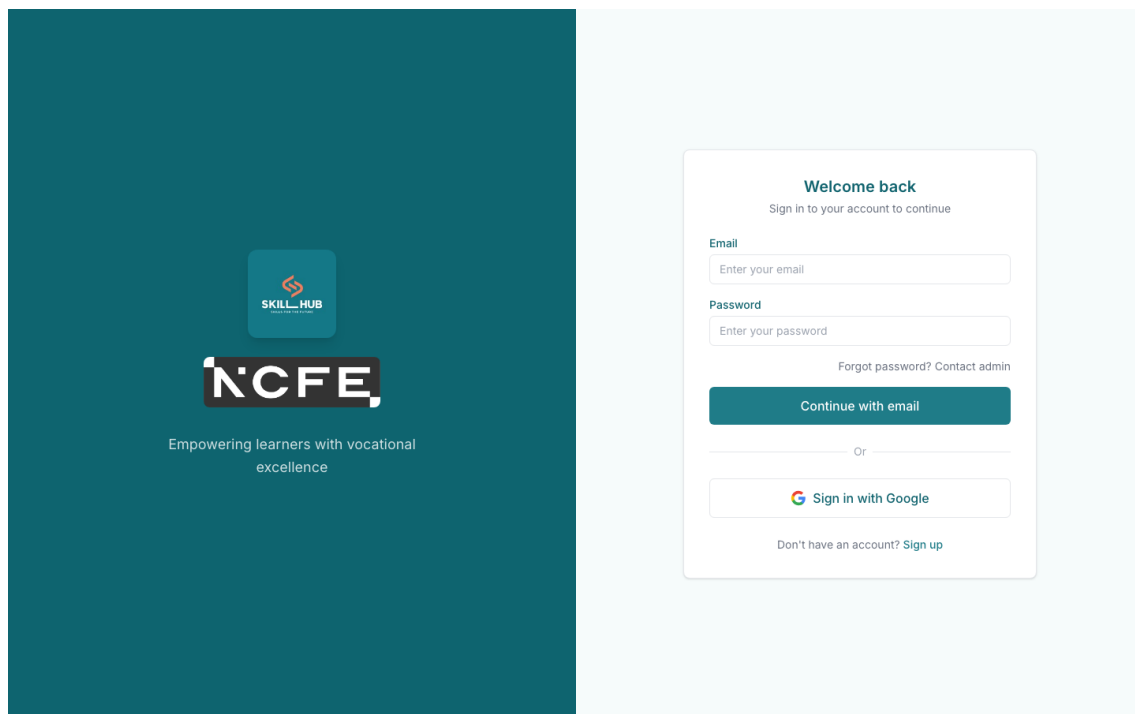
<https://ncfe-lms.onrender.com>

Where to get help

All account, password, and enrolment questions go to your centre administrator. Self-service password reset is intentionally disabled — admin holds password ownership by design.

2. Signing in

Open <https://ncfe-lms.onrender.com/sign-in>, enter your email and password, click **Continue with email**.

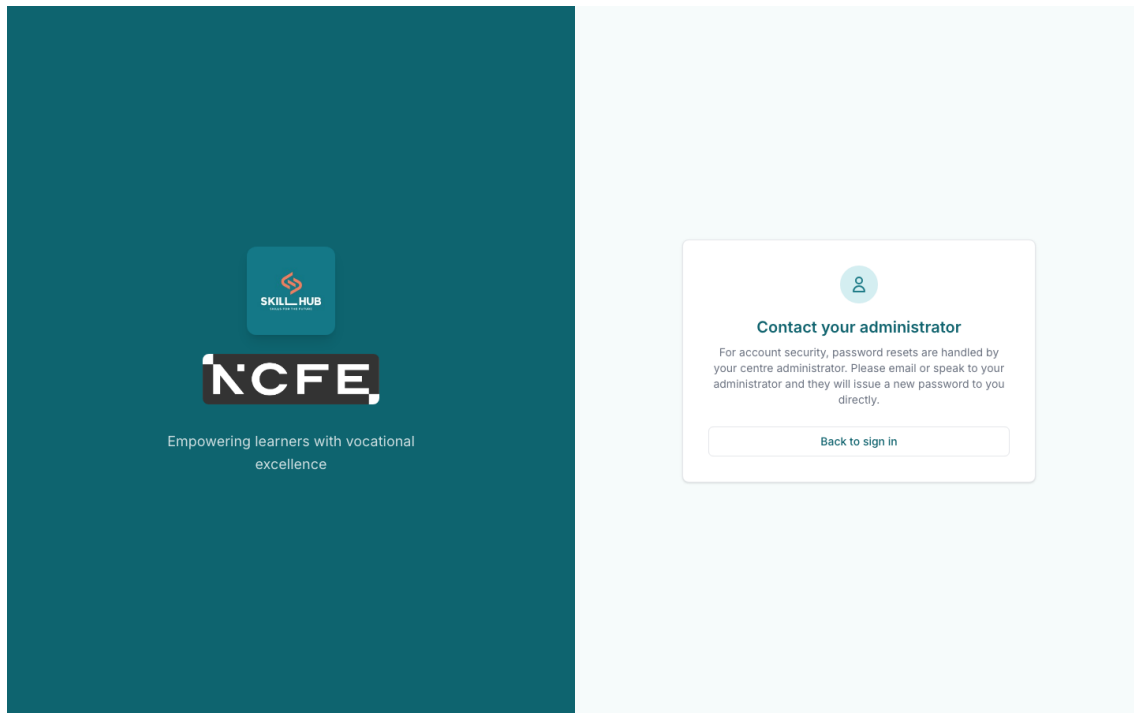


Sign-in page

Where each role lands after sign-in

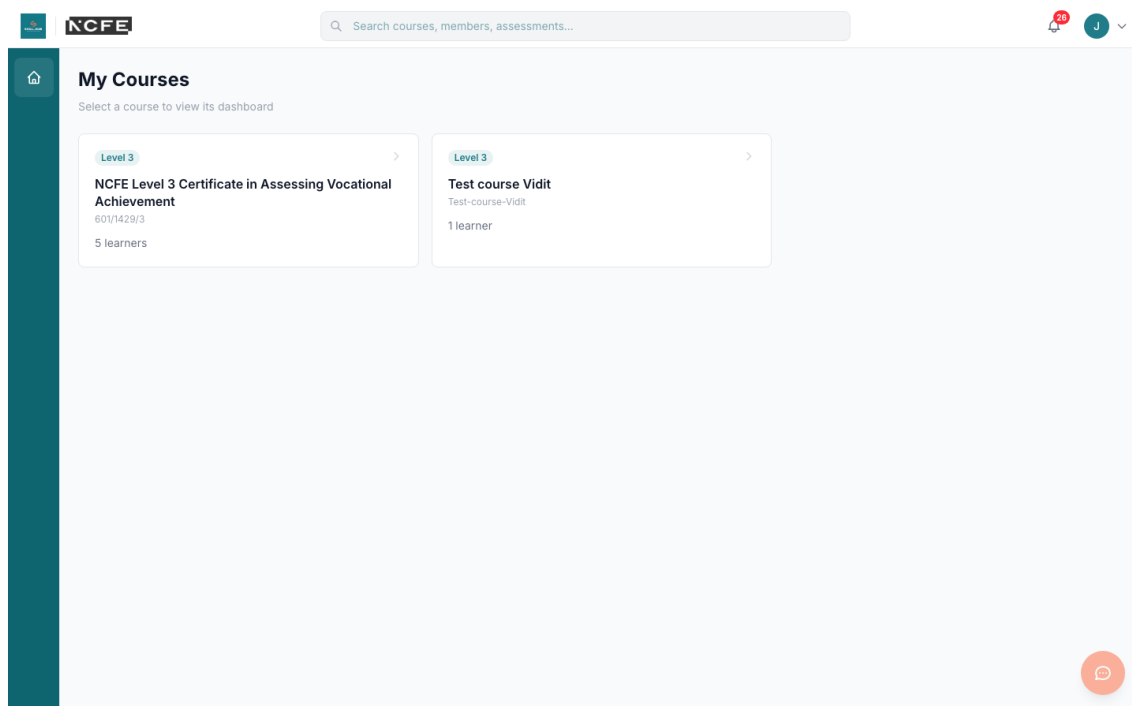
Role	Lands on
Admin	/admin/dashboard
Assessor	/c (course list)
Student	/c (course list)
IQA	/dashboard (IQA home)

Forgot your password? Click **Forgot password? Contact admin** on the sign-in page. You will see a contact-administrator notice. Self-service password reset is disabled by design. Email your centre administrator and they will issue a new password.



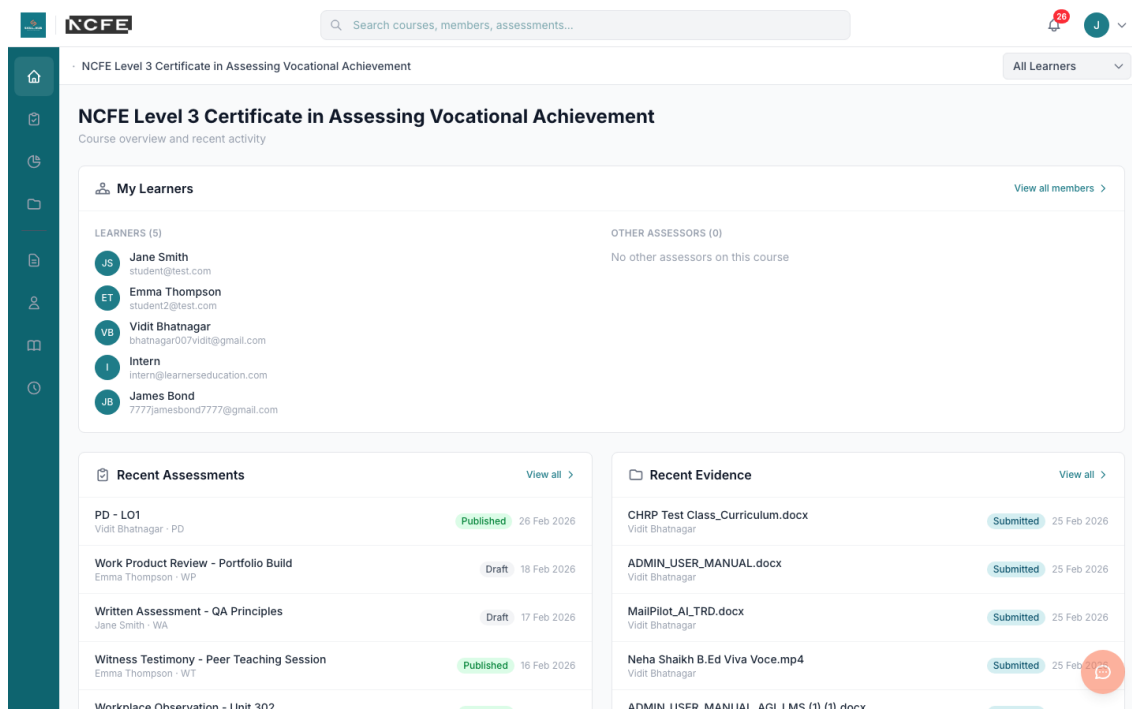
Forgot-password notice

3. Assessor tasks



Course list at `/c`

`/c` is your home — every qualification you assess shows as a card. Click into one to enter that course's dashboard.



Course home at `/c/{slug}`

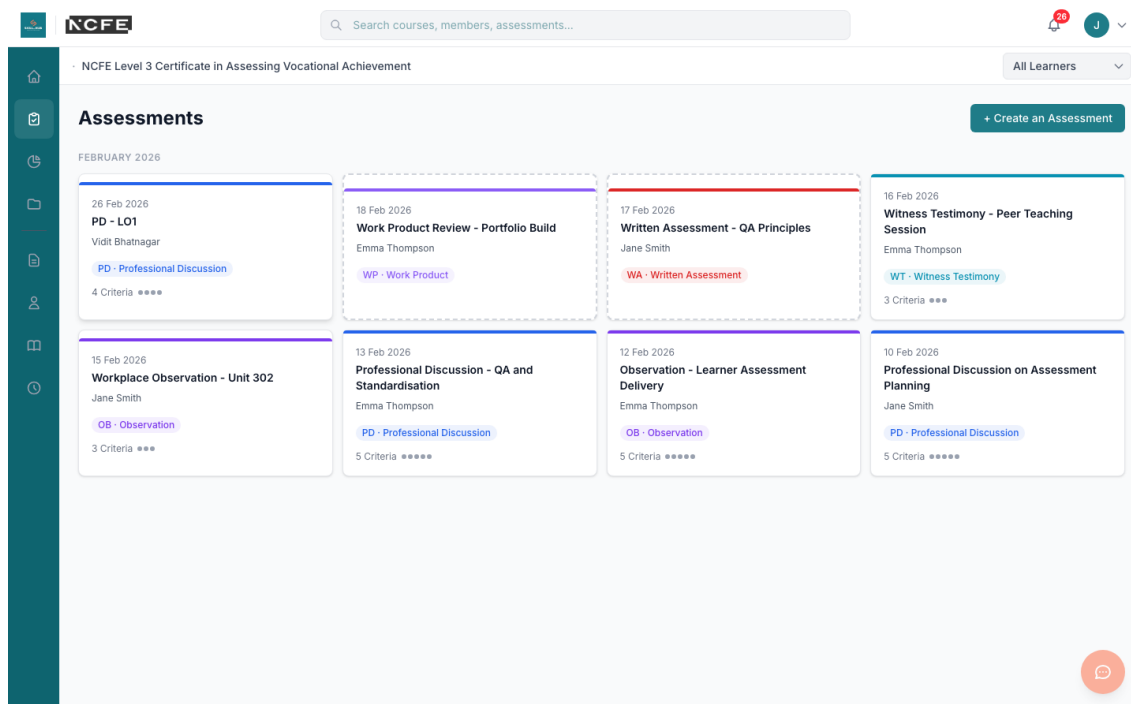
The course home shows recent assessments, recent evidence, and recent materials. The **Learners** dropdown in the sub-header switches your view between the cohort's learners.

Sidebar reference

Icon	Page	What you do here
■	Home	Recent activity overview
✓	Assessment	Plan, map, sign off assessments
■	Progress	Drill into Units → LOs → Criteria for the selected learner
■	Portfolio	All evidence the selected learner has uploaded
■	Course Documents	Documents shared with the cohort
■	Personal Documents	Per-learner documents
■	Materials	Learning materials
■	Work Hours	Log + view work hours

3.1 Plan an assessment

- 1 Pick a learner from the **Learners** ■ dropdown in the sub-header.
- 2 Sidebar → **Assessment** → click **+ Create an Assessment**.
- 3 In the detail panel that slides in from the right, set the **title**, **kind** (observation / professional discussion / reflective account / verbal / written / work product / witness testimony), and fill in **plan / intent** and **plan / implementation**.
- 4 Open the **Criteria Mapping** modal, expand units, tick the criteria this assessment will evidence. Save — the chips render in the panel.



Assessment list at `/c/{slug}/assessment`

3.2 Map evidence and sign off

- 1 Open the assessment.
- 2 **Evidence Mapping** section — click **Upload Evidence** to attach a fresh file, or pick from the available evidence list to link existing portfolio uploads.
- 3 Add a **Remark** if you have feedback (general comment on the assessment).
- 4 Click **Send to learner** — the assessment moves from *draft* to *published*.
- 5 If the learner has not opted out, they receive a 'Your assessment has been reviewed' email and an in-app notification. They will then open the assessment, review your remark, and sign off.

Re-editing after publish. If you change the assessment after publishing, the status flips to *published_modified* until you click **Send to learner** again.

3.3 Leave per-criterion comments

Comments scoped to a specific Assessment Criterion (rather than the assessment as a whole) are supported via API. Each AC chip in the assessment will display its comment thread when expanded.

Both assessors and IQAs can post and delete their own comments; students see them read-only when they open the assessment.

3.4 Export an assessment as PDF

On the assessment detail panel, the **PDF** button (next to Delete) downloads a complete record: header, plan / intent, plan / implementation, mapped criteria, mapped evidence, sign-offs, and remarks. Useful for portfolio audits, IQA folders, and EQA submission packs. Both you and the learner can export the same assessment.

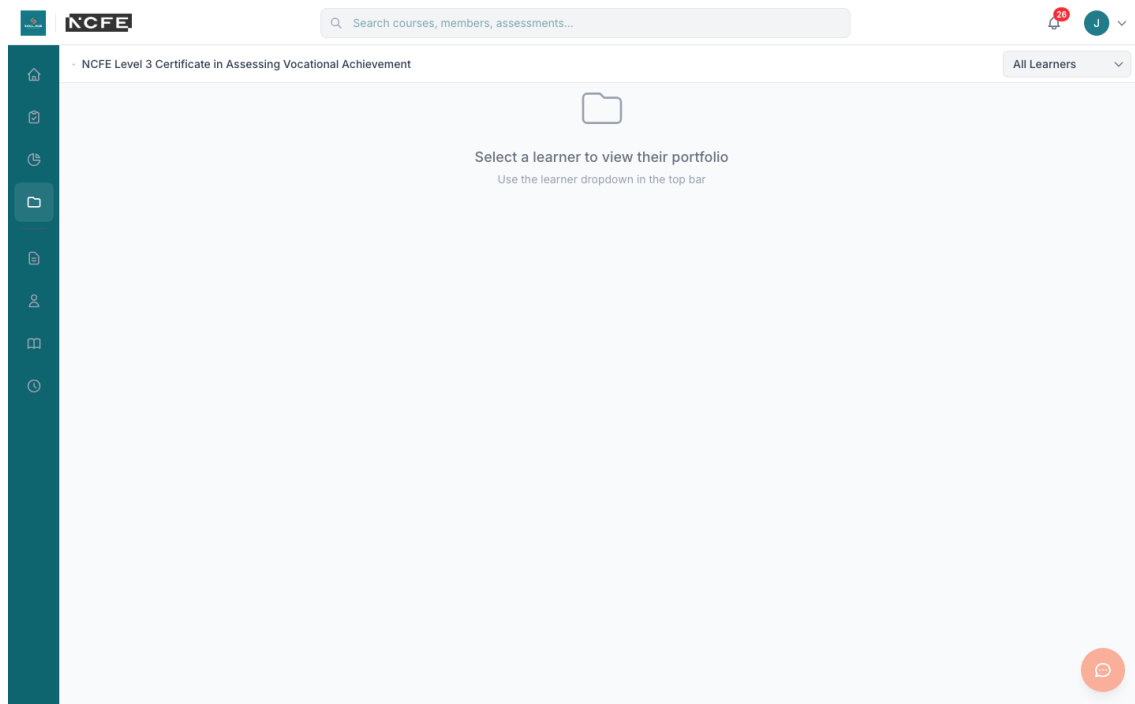
3.5 Witness testimony evidence

When uploading or accepting evidence whose **Evidence kind** is *witness_testimony*, the upload modal shows a witness block:

- **Witness name**
- **Witness role** (e.g. Senior Carer, Site Supervisor)
- **Witness employer**
- **Witness email**
- **Witness statement** (free text)

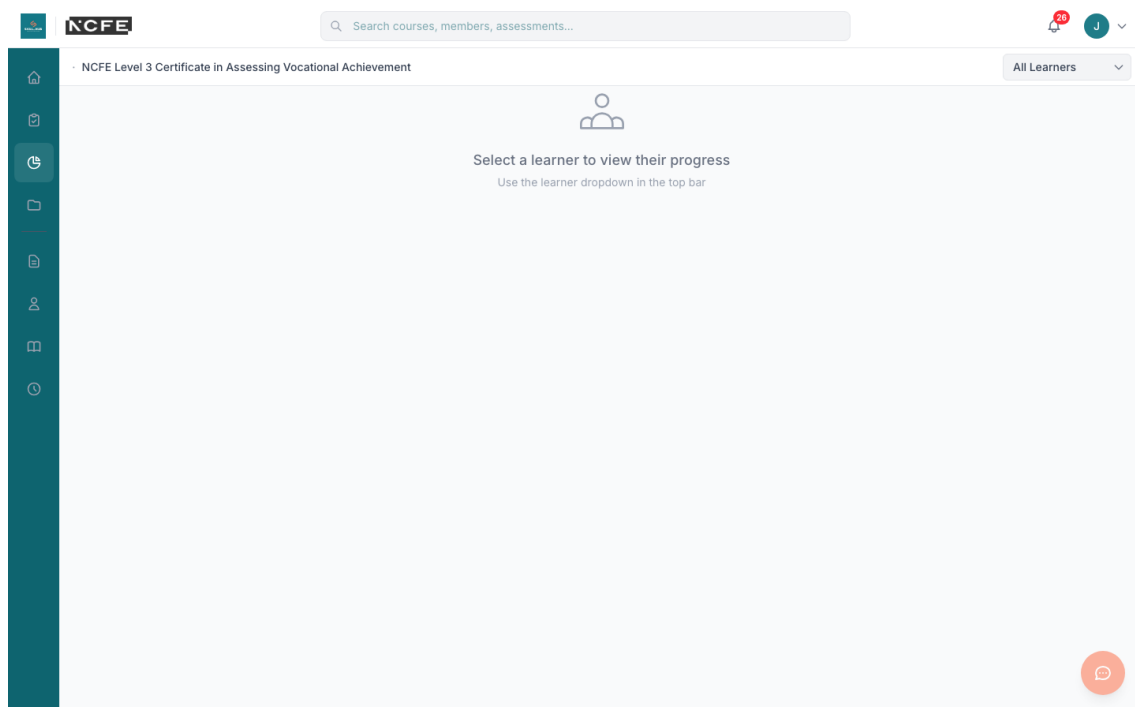
These fields are stored on the Evidence record and travel with it into your assessment.

3.6 Review portfolio and progress



Portfolio at `/c/{slug}/portfolio`

Sidebar → **Portfolio** shows every piece of evidence the selected learner has uploaded. Video evidence renders with an auto-generated thumbnail (one-second snapshot) so you can identify recordings at a glance — when the codec is unusual or generation fails the upload still succeeds and a generic file icon is shown instead.



Progress at `/c/{slug}/progress`

Sidebar → **Progress** is a 4-column drill-down — Units → Learning Outcomes → Assessment Criteria → Assessments. Use this to see which ACs are signed off and which are still outstanding for the selected learner.

3.7 Log work hours on behalf of a learner

Sidebar → **Work Hours**. Pick a date with the day navigator, click **+ New**, enter hours and a note. If the qualification has a Required Work Hours target set, a progress bar at the top shows logged-vs-required with a percentage and turns green when the target is met.

4. Reference

4.1 Evidence kinds

Kind	When to use
observation	Direct observation of the learner performing a task
professional_discussion	Structured one-to-one discussion with the learner
reflective_account	Learner-written reflection on their work
verbal_assessment	Verbal questioning with notes on responses
written_assessment	Written test, essay, or report
work_product	An artefact the learner produced in their job role
witness_testimony	Statement from a third party (e.g. employer)

4.2 File upload limits

Setting	Value
Max single file size	2 GB
Avatar limit	2 MB (PNG / JPEG / WEBP / GIF)
Documents	.pdf, .doc, .docx, .xls, .xlsx, .ppt, .pptx, .txt
Images	.png, .jpg, .jpeg, .gif, .webp
Video / audio	.mp4, .mov, .avi, .mp3, .wav, .m4a
Other	.zip
Storage	AWS S3 (region ap-south-1); large evidence via presigned URLs

4.3 Email notifications you trigger

Action	Email goes to	Honors opt-out?
You publish an assessment (send to learner)	The learner	Yes
IQA records a decision on your assessment	You + the learner	Yes

Email failures are **soft-fail**. If your sign-off triggers an email and the email service is down, the sign-off itself still succeeds — the learner just doesn't get the notification. Failures are recorded in the audit log for the centre admin.

4.4 Recently shipped assessor features

Feature	What it does
Per-criterion comments	Leave feedback scoped to a specific Assessment Criterion via expandable AC chip.
PDF export of an assessment	Single-click download of the full assessment record.
Video thumbnails on evidence	Auto-generated 1-second snapshot renders in portfolio, evidence selection modal, and
Witness testimony fields	When evidence kind is witness_testimony, the upload modal captures structured witne
Required work hours progress	Top-of-page progress bar on /c/{slug}/work-hours when admin sets a required total on
Empty / loading / error states	Every list page shows a friendly placeholder when empty or loading, with a retry button

5. Assessor FAQ

Q. How do I switch between learners in a course?

A. Use the **Learners** ■ dropdown in the sub-header. The current selection persists across the sidebar pages so you can move from Assessment to Progress to Portfolio for the same learner without re-picking.

Q. Can I edit an assessment after publishing it?

A. Yes. The status flips from *published* to *published_modified* while you are editing. Click **Send to learner** again to re-publish — that generates a fresh notification email if the learner has not opted out.

Q. What's the difference between Remark and per-criterion comment?

A. A **Remark** is one piece of free-text attached to the assessment as a whole. A **per-criterion comment** is scoped to a specific Assessment Criterion chip, so feedback like 'AC 1.2 needs more detail on regulations' lives next to the criterion rather than buried in a top-level remark.

Q. How do I undo a sign-off?

A. Re-open the assessment and edit it. The status drops to *published_modified* and the sign-off is effectively reset until you re-publish. The audit log preserves the original.

Q. A learner uploaded a video but I don't see a thumbnail. Why?

A. The server tries to extract a 1-second snapshot at upload time. It quietly skips when the codec is unusual, the file is malformed, or extraction takes longer than 30 seconds. The upload itself still succeeds — only the preview falls back to the generic file icon. If the file looks healthy and you want a thumbnail, ask the learner to re-encode as standard H.264 / mp4 and re-upload.

Q. How do I export an assessment as PDF for an IQA folder?

A. On the assessment detail panel, click the **PDF** button next to Delete. The file downloads with the assessment's title in the filename. The PDF includes plan / intent, plan / implementation, mapped criteria, mapped evidence, sign-offs, and remarks.

Q. I forgot my password.

A. Email your centre administrator. Self-service reset is disabled by design; admin will issue a new password and email it to you.

Q. Can I change my email address?

A. No — your email is your sign-in identifier. Ask your centre administrator to update it on /admin/users → Edit.

Q. What happens when I get an IQA decision?

A. You and the learner both receive an 'IQA decision recorded' email (unless you've opted out in /profile). Open the IQA decisions list or the original assessment to see the rationale and any actions the IQA recorded.

Q. How do I log work hours on behalf of a learner?

A. Pick the learner from the Learners dropdown, sidebar → **Work Hours**, click **+ New**, fill in the date / hours / note. If the qualification has a Required Work Hours target the progress bar at the top updates immediately.